invasion began, India publicly expressed 'its deep regret that in spite of the friendly and disinterested advice repeatedly tendered by them, the Chinese government should have decided to seek a solution of the problem of their relations with Tibet by force'. [9] The Chinese neatly turned the tables by alleging that it was all India's fault that negotiations between the Chinese and Tibetans could not take place because of 'outside instigation'.

The Government of India's strategy in pursuance of its objective of legitimizing the frontier and retaining all the rights and privileges that it had inherited in Tibet from the British Empire, was crafted differently. The Government of India's official agents in Tibet regularly sent reports about the inevitability of a Chinese invasion, and recommended that India should meet Tibet's requirement of arms and ammunition, and extend its diplomatic and political support to the Tibetan government. H. Dayal, India's political officer in Sikkim, advised the government in New Delhi that once the Communist armies had occupied Tibet, it would encourage them to press their country's long-standing claims to portions of Assam and revive pretentions to suzerainty over the Himalayan states. Dayal went on to add that it might also be too late then to negotiate with the Chinese on Indian interests there, and that even the continuance of the Indian Mission in Lhasa would come into question. [10] However, in New Delhi, a different set of considerations dictated India's policy.

The Government of India felt that the Communist regime was there to stay and it was desirable to have cordial relations with this new regime. India's Political Officer in Gangtok, H. Dayal, who was familiar with the Himalayan region and its politics, was concerned that the larger objective of good relations with the Communist regime in China should not deter India from at least flagging its position on the Tibetan issue. 'The